

Kill Team Core Rules — How to Play Guide

A clear, player-friendly breakdown of how Kill Team 3rd Edition works.

What You Need

- ▶ Two kill teams (each with their own datacards)
- ▶ 10+ six-sided dice (D6)
- ▶ Tokens/order markers
- ▶ A measuring tape
- ▶ A killzone (game board) with terrain

The Big Picture: How a Game Flows

A Kill Team game is played over Turning Points (typically 4). Each turning point has two phases:

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Turning Point
├─ 1. Strategy Phase   ← gain CP, use plays
└─ 2. Firefight Phase ← activate operatives, shoot, fight
  
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Repeat until all turning points are done. Victory is determined by mission objectives.

STRATEGY PHASE (3 Steps)

Step 1 — Initiative

- ▶ One player has initiative this turning point (they activate first and break ties).
- ▶ Turning point 1: the mission pack decides who has it.
- ▶ Turning points 2+: both players roll off; ties go to the player who did not have it last turn.

Step 2 — Ready

- Initiative player: 1 CP
- Non-initiative player: 2 CP (a small compensation bonus)
- ▶ Each player gains Command Points (CP):
- ▶ All your operatives become ready (flip order tokens to the light side).

Step 3 — Gambit

- ▶ Starting with the initiative player, players alternate using Strategic Gambits (mostly Strategy Plays).
- ▶ Spending CP on a play gives you a rules bonus for the turn.
- ▶ Once both players pass consecutively, the Gambit step ends.
- ▶ Each Strategic Gambit can only be used once per turning point.

FIREFIGHT PHASE

Players alternate activating one ready operative at a time. Initiative player goes first.

When it's your turn to activate, pick a ready operative and do 3 things:

Step 1 — Determine Order

Give the operative either:

Order	Benefits	Restrictions
Engage	Full actions, can Counteract	No special protection
Conceal	Not a valid target while in cover	Cannot Shoot, Charge, or Counteract

Tip: Use Conceal on operatives you want to keep alive while repositioning. Use Engage on operatives ready to fight.

Step 2 — Perform Actions

The operative spends Action Points (AP) up to their Action Point Limit (APL) — usually 2.

- ▶ You cannot perform the same action more than once per activation.
- ▶ If an action is cancelled mid-way, you don't spend the AP.

Step 3 — Expended

After the operative is done, flip their token to the dark side (expended). They're done this turning point.

ACTIONS

Movement Actions

Action	AP Cost	What it Does
Reposition	1	Move up to your Move stat. Cannot enter enemy control range unless a friendly is already there. Cannot combine with Fall Back or Charge.
Dash	1	Move up to 3". Cannot climb. Cannot combine with Charge. Cannot start/end in enemy control range.
Fall Back	2	Move while in enemy control range. Must start in control range; cannot end there. Cannot combine with Reposition or Charge.
Charge	1	Move up to Move + 2". Must end within enemy control range. Requires Engage order. Cannot combine with Reposition, Dash, or Fall Back.

Vertical Movement

- ▶ Climb: Must be within 1" horizontally and 3" vertically of terrain. Each climb counts as minimum 2" of movement.
- ▶ Drop: Ignore the first 2" of vertical distance when dropping (per action).
- ▶ Jump: From Vantage terrain higher than 2" above the floor, you can jump up to 4" horizontally.

Combat Actions

Action	AP Cost	What it Does
Shoot	1	Ranged attack. Requires Engage order and not be in enemy control range.
Fight	1	Melee attack. Must have an enemy in your control range.

Objective Actions

Action	AP Cost	What it Does
Pick Up Marker	1	Grab a controllable marker you're controlling. Cannot be in enemy control range or already carrying a marker.
Place Marker	1	Put down a carried marker within your control range. (If incapacitated, this costs 0 AP and happens automatically before removal.)

COUNTERACT

When all your operatives are expended but your opponent still has ready ones, you don't just sit there — you Counteract.

- ▶ Pick an expended operative with an Engage order.
- ▶ They perform one free 1AP action (excluding Guard).
- ▶ They cannot move more than 2" while counteracting.
- ▶ Each operative can Counteract once per turning point.
- ▶ This is NOT a normal activation — it's a reaction.

SHOOTING (Step-by-Step)

1. Select Weapon

Collect D6s equal to the weapon's Atk (Attack) stat.

2. Select Valid Target

The target must be visible to your operative.

- ▶ If the target has a Conceal order AND is in cover → they are not a valid target.
- ▶ You cannot shoot if friendly operatives are within the target's control range (1").

3. Roll Attack Dice

Roll all your attack dice. A success = roll equal to or higher than the weapon's Hit stat.

- ▶ Roll a 6 = always a critical success (better damage).
- ▶ Roll a 1 = always a failure.

Obscured target (enemy is behind Heavy terrain, >1" away from both operatives):

- ▶ Discard one success from your roll.
- ▶ All critical successes become normal successes.

4. Roll Defence Dice

The defender rolls 3 defence dice. A success = roll equal to or higher than their Save stat.

Cover bonus: If the defender is in cover (and has Engage order), they keep one free normal success automatically — before rolling.

5. Resolve Defence Dice

The defender uses their successes to block attacker successes:

- ▶ Normal success blocks 1 normal success.
- ▶ 2 normal successes can block 1 critical success.
- ▶ Critical success blocks any 1 success (normal or critical).

6. Resolve Damage

Each unblocked attacker success inflicts damage:

- ▶ Normal success → Normal Damage (from weapon stat)
- ▶ Critical success → Critical Damage (from weapon stat, usually higher)

Reduce the target's Wounds by the damage total. If Wounds reach 0 or less → Incapacitated → removed from the killzone.

FIGHTING (Melee — Step-by-Step)

1. Select Enemy Operative

Pick an enemy in your control range (within 1" and visible).

The enemy operative will retaliate this same action.

2. Select Weapons & Roll

- ▶ Both players pick their melee weapon and collect dice (Atk stat).
- ▶ Both players roll simultaneously.
- ▶ Hit successes work the same as shooting (meet or beat the Hit stat; 6 = crit; 1 = fail).

Assisted Fighting: If friendly operatives (not themselves in another enemy's control range) are within the enemy's control range, your melee Hit stat improves by 1 for each assisting operative.

3. Alternate Resolving Dice

Players take turns resolving one die at a time:

- Normal blocks Normal.
- Critical blocks either Normal or Critical.
- ▶ Strike — inflict damage (normal or critical) and discard the die.
- ▶ Block — allocate to cancel an opponent's unresolved success.

Keep going until one operative is incapacitated or all dice are resolved.

KEY CONCEPTS

Control Range

An operative is in control range of another if they are:

- ▶ Within 1" AND
- ▶ Visible to each other

Control range is mutual — it applies to both operatives simultaneously.

Cover

An operative is in cover if there is intervening terrain within their control range.

However, you cannot be in cover if you are within 2" of the attacker.

Obscured vs. In Cover

- These are two different things:
- ▶ In cover = terrain is between you and the attacker, within your control range → defender gets a cover save.
 - ▶ Obscured = Heavy terrain is between attacker and target, more than 1" from either → attacker loses a success and crits become normals.

Wounds & Injury

State	Condition	Penalty
Healthy	At or above starting Wounds	None
Injured	Below half starting Wounds	-2" Move, -1 to Hit (worse)
Incapacitated	0 or fewer Wounds	Removed from killzone

Visibility

An operative is visible if you can draw a straight unobstructed line (1mm wide, imaginary) from your operative's head to any part of the target's miniature (not just the base).

An operative is always visible to itself.

Markers & Objectives

- ▶ Objective markers: 40mm diameter.
- ▶ Other markers: 20mm diameter.
- ▶ An operative contests a marker if within control range of it.
- ▶ An operative controls a marker if the total APL of friendly operatives contesting it exceeds the enemy's total APL on the same marker.
- ▶ A carried marker is automatically controlled by the carrier.

COMMAND POINTS & PLOYS

Command Points (CP) are the currency for activating ploys.

Ploy Type	When Used	Notes
Strategy Ploys	Gambit step (Strategy Phase)	These are Strategic Gambits
Firefight Ploys	Firefight Phase	Used during the action phase
Command Re-roll	Anytime (1 CP)	Re-roll one attack or defence die

- Rules:
- ▶ Each non-Command ploy can only be used once per turning point.
 - ▶ You cannot use the same Strategic Gambit more than once per turning point.

DATACARDS

Every operative has a datacard that lists:

Stat	What It Means
APL	Action Point Limit — how many actions per activation
Move	Distance in inches for Reposition/Charge (minimum 4")
Save	Defence dice target number (lower = better saves)
Wounds	How much damage they can take
Atk	Number of attack dice for a weapon
Hit	Roll needed to score a success (lower = more hits)
Normal Dmg	Damage per normal success
Critical Dmg	Damage per critical success

APL modifiers cannot exceed ± 1 from the base value.

DICE RULES

- ▶ A success = rolling equal to or higher than the target number (e.g., 3+ means 3, 4, 5, or 6).
- ▶ 6 = always a critical success on attack dice.
- ▶ 1 = always a failure on attack dice.
- ▶ Re-rolls: Each die can be re-rolled once. You cannot re-roll a die that was already re-rolled.
- ▶ Multiple simultaneous re-rolls: Players alternate choosing to re-roll a die or pass, starting with the initiative player. Continue until both pass.
- ▶ D3: Roll a D6 and halve the result (round up). So: 1-2=1, 3-4=2, 5-6=3.

PRECEDENCE (When Rules Conflict)

Kill Team uses this priority order:

1. An explicit statement that overrides normal rules
2. Designer commentary / FAQ
3. Non-core rules (faction rules, mission rules) beat core rules
4. "Cannot" beats "can"
5. The active player decides (when activating/acting)
6. The initiative player decides (all other ties)

WEAPON SPECIAL RULES

Weapons can have one or more special rules (keywords) printed on their datacard. Here's what every keyword does:

Re-roll Rules

Keyword	Effect
Balanced	Re-roll one of your attack dice.
Relentless	Re-roll any of your attack dice (as many as you want).
Ceaseless	Re-roll any dice showing one specific result (e.g. all your 2s).

Auto-Success Rules

Keyword	Effect
Accurate x	Retain up to x attack dice as normal successes without rolling them (free hits).
Lethal x+	Any success rolled at x or higher counts as a critical success instead. E.g. Lethal 5+ means 5s and 6s are both crits.

Converting Successes

Keyword	Effect
Rending	If you retained any crits, you may also convert one normal success to a critical.
Severe	If you have no crits, you may change one normal success to a critical.
Punishing	If you retained any crits, you may also retain one failed die as a normal success.

Defence-Reducing Rules

Keyword	Effect
Piercing x	Defender collects x fewer defence dice. E.g. Piercing 1 means they roll only 2 dice instead of 3.
Saturate	Defender cannot retain cover saves. Bypasses cover entirely.
Seek	When picking targets, operatives cannot use terrain for cover.
Brutal	Your opponent can only block with critical successes (normal successes are useless for blocking).

Melee-Specific Rules

Keyword	Effect
Shock	The first time you strike with a crit in the sequence, also discard one of your opponent's unresolved normal successes.

Debuff Rules

Keyword	Effect
Stun	If you retain any crits, subtract 1 from the target's APL until the end of their next activation (they get fewer actions).

Area / Multi-Target Rules

Keyword	Effect
Blast x	After shooting the primary target, also shoot against every other operative visible and within x" of the primary (each rolled separately). Cover/obscured status of secondary targets matches the primary target's.
Torrent x	Pick a primary target normally, then pick any number of other valid targets within x" of it (not in friendly control range) as secondary targets. Shoot against all of them separately.

Restriction Rules

Keyword	Effect
Heavy	Cannot use this weapon in an activation where you moved, and cannot move in an activation where you used this weapon.
Hot	After using, roll 1D6. If the result is less than the weapon's Hit stat, the operative takes damage equal to the result × 2.
Limited x	After using this weapon x times total in the battle, it's gone.
Range x	Can only target operatives within x". E.g. Range 9" limits you to close-range shots.

Special Action Rules

Keyword	Effect
Silent	The operative can perform the Shoot action while having a Conceal order (normally you can't shoot on Conceal).
Devastating x	Each critical success immediately inflicts x bonus damage on top of the weapon's normal critical damage.

EQUIPMENT

Equipment gives your operatives extra tools and options. Selected before the battle as part of your game sequence.

Rules:

- ▶ Universal equipment — any kill team can use it.
- ▶ Faction equipment — specific to your kill team (listed in team rules).
- ▶ You cannot select the same equipment option more than once per game.

Universal Equipment Options

Equipment	What It Does
Ammo Cache (×1)	Place a cache marker. Operatives within control range can use a free OAP Ammo Resupply action to re-roll one attack die until the next turning point.
Razor Wire (×1)	Deploy terrain. Operatives moving within 1" of it treat that distance as 1" longer (slows movement). Counts as Exposed and Obstructing terrain.
Comms Device (×1)	Place a marker. While friendly controlled, extends support rule ranges by 3". Cannot benefit from the opponent's Comms Device.

Equipment	What It Does
Mines (×1)	Place a marker. When any operative enters its control range, it triggers and inflicts D3+3 damage on that operative.
Light Barricades (×2)	Two pieces of Light terrain. Provide cover. Feet are insignificant/exposed.
Heavy Barricade (×1)	One piece of Heavy terrain providing robust cover. Must be placed wholly within 4" of your drop zone.
Ladders (×2)	Insignificant terrain. When climbing within control range of a ladder, treat the vertical distance as only 1" (makes climbing cheap).
Portable Barricade (×1)	A personal Light terrain shield. Improves the carrying operative's Save stat by 1 (max 2+). Can be repositioned with the Move with Barricade action.
Utility Grenades	Two grenade-style limited-use actions. Typically smoke/stun combinations (exact options vary by selection).
Explosive Grenades	Two grenade options: Frag (4 Atk, 4+ Hit, 2/4 Dmg, Blast 2", Saturate) and Krak (4 Atk, 4+ Hit, 4/5 Dmg, Piercing 1, Saturate). Limited use.
Breaching Charge (×1)	One-use. Breach actions cost 1 fewer AP (minimum 1AP).

QUICK REFERENCE SUMMARY

EACH TURNING POINT:

1. Strategy Phase
 - a. Initiative – who goes first?
 - b. Ready – gain CP (1 or 2), all operatives become ready
 - c. Gambit – spend CP on ploys
2. Firefight Phase
 - Alternate activating operatives (initiative player first)
 - Each activation: Give Order → Do Actions → Expend
 - When your operatives are all expended → Counteract instead

WHEN SHOOTING:

Roll Atk dice → hit on Hit value (6=crit, 1=miss)
 Defender rolls 3 defence dice + 1 auto if in cover
 Defender blocks with successes
 Remaining hits deal Normal or Critical Damage

WHEN FIGHTING:

Both roll simultaneously → alternate: Strike or Block
 Critical > Normal for blocking priority

ORDERS:

Engage = full actions + counteract, no free cover
 Conceal = in cover = untargetable, no shooting/charging

COVER = intervening terrain in your control range, **NOT** within 2" of attacker
 OBSCURED = Heavy terrain between you and target (attacker loses 1 success, no crits)
 CONTROL RANGE = within 1" AND visible
 INJURED = below half wounds → -2" Move, -1 Hit

Source: Wahapedia Kill Team 3rd Edition Core Rules (Core Book, February 2026)